

Appendix A: Temporarily closing or restricting access to roads

A.1 General

New

This Appendix will outline the options available for temporarily closing or restricting access to roads. The available options will vary based on the road owner (state-controlled or other road owner including local government).

In most cases the need to temporarily close or restrict access to roads will be in response to natural disasters such as flooding, bushfire and other hazardous events, however the same approach may be taken when closing or restricting access to roads for planned road works.

A.2 Closing or restricting access on a state-controlled road only

New

A state-controlled road may be temporarily closed or have access restricted as per the provisions of the *Transport Infrastructure Act 1994* (TIA) Section 46, Temporary restrictions on use of state-controlled roads (SCR). A restricted road use notice (RRUN) is used to advise the road user or other persons of how the SCR is restricted and the penalty for driving past the RRUN. The TIA provisions are enforceable under the Act and only apply to state-controlled roads.

The signs in Figures A.2.1, A.2.2 and A.2.3 below are RRUN examples of the multi-message sign arrangements conforming to the requirements of the TIA and the MUTCD. The combination of the black on white messages in the top two panels that include the condition of the closure or restriction and state the penalty – are required for enforcement. They can either be in the one sign or as a multi-message arrangement with the DUE TO FLOODING black on yellow message and the LOCAL ACCESS PERMITS EXCEPTED black on white message being complementary to the enforcement sign but are not required for enforcement.

Barrier boards are required each side of a road closed arrangement (see Figure A.2.2) to completely block access to the roadway at the site of any road closure.

It is important where access to a road is restricted that the start and end points of the restriction are identified by RRUN. The end of the road restriction is also identified by a RRUN which terminates the restriction (see Figure A.2.3). The end of a temporary road closure is not required as the road would be closed for traffic trying to access at the opposite end by a RRUN facing them.